



SEM Operational/Execution: SSM

This course describes the "nuts and bolts" when it comes to the SEM operational/execution processes.

It covers:

- **WHAT** we need to do....in other words, operational tasks.
- **HOW** we are to do it...in other words, execution of those tasks.
- **WHY** we do it...in other words, a little context.

≡ Key Role Responsibilities

≡ Approval Workflow

≡ Order and Setup Responsibilities

≡ Client Campaign Pause/Reallocation

Key Role Responsibilities



A successful SEM campaign starts with clear ownership. From gathering client requirements to building and launching the campaign, each role plays a critical part in ensuring orders are processed accurately and efficiently.

For SEM, the SSM role's primary responsibility is to process and submit the order. Check off the SSM tasks below:

☐

Manage order setup workflows.

☐

Complete required order documentation.

☐

Process fulfillment-related requests and cases.

☐

Follow ordering references and onboarding procedures.

☐

Assure custom pricing is approved/executed.

CONTINUE

Approval Workflow



For most SEM campaigns, the sales rep prices based on the standard DMS rate card. However, there can be situations where they need to deviate from the standard. For example, they might have a long term customer who agrees to a new two year agreement in exchange for custom pricing.

To that end, Financial Approvals (fondly known as "FAs") are used for processes that require oversight, such as price overrides

or minimum term variations. Below are the steps for how FAs come to be.

Step 1

The sales rep enters the FA into Salesforce.

Step 2

The FA goes to Finance for approval.

Step 3

Once the FA is approved, the sales rep can pitch the custom pricing/terms to the customer and ultimately include it in the agreement once the sale is won (hopefully!).

Step 4

The sales rep attaches the approved FA when synching the opportunity.



SSM FA Steps

Once the sales rep has an approved FA, that's where you come in! See the steps below:

SSM Steps

1

If the sales rep is asking for off rate card/custom pricing or terms, SSMs should verify that they have an approved FA. SSMs should not move forward in the process without an FA.

2

If the sales rep does not attach the FA during the opportunity synching process, the SSM must attach it to the order in AdPoint.

3

When booking in AdPoint, SSMs must manually override the pricing/budget or book the SEM

campaign with the special term based on the FA.

4

Orders with price/minimum term/budget overrides go to approval to the Sales Operations team. If an order is rejected for a missing/incorrect FA, the SSM must work with the sales rep on correction.

5

After any issues with rejected orders are corrected, the SSM must revoke the rejection for the order to move on in the workflow. Details on revoking are found in the *Fulfillment Team Quick Reference Guide*.

Key Financial Approval Types

Below are definitions of the key Financial Approval (FA) types that relate to DMS SEM campaigns.

Agreement Custom FA

This is used to gain approval for agreements using off-rate card pricing, such as custom rates, custom margins, etc.

Example:

You are requesting custom rates or custom margins for a long term customer.

To learn more see the *Sales Custom Contract FA Quick Reference Guide*.

Digital-DMS Below Minimum Commitment Term/Spend FAs —

These are used to gain approval for any DMS campaigns under the minimum required spend per cycle or under the minimum commitment term. Anything under the minimum spend/commitment as shown on the DMS rate card requires this FA.

Example:

SEM/Search Marketing has a minimum 4 month cycle commitment required. The customer has a unique situation that warrants a 3 cycle campaign. You submit an FA to gain approval.

To learn more see the *Sales General FA Quick Reference Guide*.

Auto Renew Opt Out FA —

This is used to opt out of Auto Renew for DMS campaigns for reasons beyond variable budget/seasonal campaigns. DMS campaigns are typically auto renewed month to month after the initial campaign period ends. To opt out a customer from this auto renew process, use this FA.

Example:

A DMS customer has a campaign that runs for a year. After that year, the customer does not want their campaign to run month to month. Use the Opt Out FA to stop auto renewing.

To learn more see the *Sales General FA Quick Reference Guide*.

CONTINUE

Order and Setup Responsibilities



Order and Setup Responsibilities are where, you, as an SSM, shine for an SEM campaign!

Ordering in AdPoint is your key responsibility for an SEM campaign. If the campaign is not ordered correctly, it is a domino effect....the campaign is not fulfilled correctly, the objective is not met, the customer is not happy and the sale rep may lose this and future sales. Let's strive to keep those dominos upright!

To order the SEM campaign correctly, you must know what the sales rep sold. To prevent a game of "Twenty Questions," the sales rep should provide the *Print and Digital Order Entry Team Ordering Template* with all the SEM campaign details required.



Before Booking: A Synched Opportunity

Before you book the SEM campaign, the sales rep should provide an Adpoint order number from their synched Salesforce opportunity. Book the SEM ads to that order.

If the sales reps do not synch their opportunity, when ads are booked, it will create a second opportunity in Salesforce, doubling revenue and causing chaos. So, be sure to ask for that synched order number!

For more details about synching, see the *Sales AdPoint Opportunity Synch Quick Reference Guide*.



Did you synch your opp?

Yes! Here's the order number and link.



Perfect! We're "in synch!"
Thanks! Bye, Bye, Bye!

SSM SEM Product Booking

There are several types of SEM products and the SSMs need to be aware of the unique AdPoint booking processes for each. See the details below.

Standard Search Campaign —

A Standard Search Marketing campaign is a digital advertising strategy that places a business in front of potential customers when they are actively searching online for relevant products, services, or solutions.

The campaign uses targeted keywords, audience data, and search engine advertising to drive qualified traffic, generate leads, increase

conversions and help businesses connect with consumers at the moment of highest purchase intent.

To book, use the *SSM Search Standard Product Booking Quick Reference* document.

Search Shopping Ads —

Search Shopping Ads are a type of search advertising that display a business's products directly within search engine results, including product images, pricing, and business information.

These ads help shoppers discover products while researching and comparing options. They place a business at the top of search results and connect with consumers who are actively looking to make a purchase.

To book, use the *SSM Search Shopping Ads Product Booking Quick Reference* document.

Search Local Services Ads (LSA) —

Local Services Ads (LSAs) are pay-for-lead advertisements that help service-based businesses appear prominently at the top of search results when potential customers are looking for local providers.

These ads connect businesses directly with consumers through phone calls and messages, generating qualified leads from people who are actively seeking services in their area.

To book, use the *SSM Search Local Services LSA Product Booking Quick Reference* document.



What Happens Next?

Once the SEM ads are entered into AdPoint, they get added to the opportunity in Salesforce. Thirty days out from the start date of the SEM campaign, onboarding cases are generated to the AM to start fulfillment work. For more details of onboarding cases, see the *Salesforce Onboarding Cases Quick Reference Guide*.

CONTINUE

Client Campaign Pause/Reallocation



Change is Inevitable

So, the campaign has been ordered (correctly, since you followed all the instructions!) and fulfilled. Yay! Time to rest, right? That nap may be short since there are often various changes needed over the course of an SEM campaign.

Click below to learn more about the typical types of changes.

Why are Changes Needed?

CAMPAIGN PAUSE

CAMPAIGN REALLOCATION

Here's some common reasons why a client might want to pause or cancel a campaign.

- **Seasonal Slowdowns**

The business experiences slower demand during certain times of the year and wants to align advertising with peak seasons.

- **Staffing or Capacity Constraints**

The client is receiving enough leads but doesn't have the staff, inventory, or resources to handle additional business.

- **Business Changes**

The company is relocating, renovating, changing services, updating pricing, or restructuring operations.

- **Budget Adjustments**

The client needs to temporarily reduce marketing spend due to cash flow, budgeting cycles, or other business priorities.

- **Creative or Messaging Updates**

The client wants to refresh ads, promotions, offers, branding, or product information before continuing the campaign.

- **Lead Quality Optimization**

The campaign is paused briefly while targeting, keywords, audiences, or bidding strategies are reviewed and optimized.

- **Inventory or Product Availability Issues**

The client may be experiencing product shortages, supply chain disruptions, or inventory constraints.

- **Business Closure or Vacation Periods**

The business is temporarily closed for holidays, vacations, or special events.



CAMPAIGN PAUSE

CAMPAIGN REALLOCATION

A reallocation typically means moving budget from an existing campaign to a different campaign, product, or strategy because the client's needs have changed.

A lot of the reasons for reallocation are the same as for a campaign pause. There are a few others as well:

- **Change in Marketing Goals**

The client wants to shift their marketing goal focus.

- **Product Mix Changes**

The client wants to move budget from one product to another, such as from Standard Search Marketing to Local Services Ads.

- **Performance Optimization**

Campaign results indicate that another marketing channel or tactic may provide better performance for the client's objectives.



How do these Changes Happen?

1

Sales reps learn that a change needs to happen to an ad. They go to Salesforce and submit a Salesforce Cancel/Modification case.

To learn more about the cases, see the *Sales Cancel Modification Adjustment Salesforce Cases Quick Reference Guide*.

SSMs receive the case and make the changes in AdPoint. They can make modifications, such as upselling or downselling a campaign. They can also cancel a campaign. For details on AdPoint edits/cancels, see the *Fulfillment Team AdPoint Quick Reference Guide*.

Conclusion



Don't Lose Your Keys

All in all, as an SSM, you are **key** in the SEM campaign fulfillment process. In fact, your order is the **key** that opens the door to a successful campaign.